

Activating Workplace Giving

A summary for the Food Bank of the Rockies development team

Prepared by a student team · Daniels College of Business, University of Denver · June 2026

Workplace giving brings in about **\$1.5M** of the Food Bank of the Rockies' roughly **\$31M** philanthropic budget today — almost entirely **passively**, with no one assigned to it. As you put it in your session, it's **low-hanging fruit** that's sat for three years. The gap is **activation, not awareness**.

The recommendation

Give it an owner. Assign a **part-time workplace-giving lead** to run it end to end — someone experienced in corporate giving, not a first-time intern. Their core job is **lead generation**: finding and signing employers with match and grant programs. **Anchor with Arrow & Prologis** — large Denver employers whose teams already volunteer with you — to prove the model fast, then **grow into the smaller, platform-less companies** you said you most want to reach.

How the money works

- **Volunteer grants.** Employers pay for staff volunteer hours (Arrow's published rate is ~\$20/hr). The volunteer pays nothing.
- **Matching gifts.** Employers double gifts staff already make.
- This is **employer money** you aren't yet collecting — without asking volunteers or donors for more.

The first 90 days — mostly free

- **Capture.** Ask "where do you work?" at volunteer check-in.
- **Match.** Add an automated match-finder (e.g., Double the Donation) to the donate page — and close the loop on match-eligible gifts.
- **Finish.** Complete the giving-platform profiles (Benevity, YourCause, Bonterra) so funds route fast.

Why it pays for itself

30-50¢

Events — cost to raise \$1 (your figure)

~4¢

A giving lead — per \$1, at scale

~4×

Return on the salary, even a conservative year

Once the program reaches \$2–3M, a lead costs roughly **3–4¢ per dollar raised** — and unlike a one-time event, it renews every year. The **free pilot proves it first**, before any real spend.

The ask

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| Assign | Name the workplace-giving lead by the end of July. |
| Activate | Run the first employer campaign before fall open enrollment closes. |
| Authorize | Approve the free first steps now — check-in capture, match-finder, platform profiles. |

Thank you for your time and candor in the guest session — this plan is built directly on what you shared.

Sources: Food Bank of the Rockies guest session (May 13, 2026); Colorado Newsline / 9News (SNAP impact); Arrow Electronics published volunteer-grant rate; Denver nonprofit salary benchmarks, ZipRecruiter / Salary.com 2026. Figures are illustrative targets; the ROI model is available on request.